

Israel

Ratio: 8:11 **Adopted:** October 28, 1948 **Usage:** National

The blue and white colors of the flag are derived from the Jewish prayer shawl



The central emblem is the Shield of David, which has a long association with the Jewish people

Asia



Israel gained independence in 1948. Until 1979 there were no set borders, only cease-fire lines. The situation of the Palestine people remains unsettled.

The flag was designed for the Zionist movement by David Wolfsohn in 1891, over 50 years before the state of Israel was officially declared.

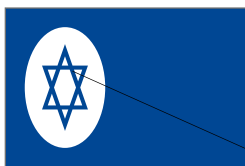
STAR OF DAVID

The central emblem in the form of a hexagram is known as the “Magen David” (Shield of David), an emblem that had been used on

Jewish flags for centuries before being adopted as the national flag of Israel. The blue and white colors are said to recall the colors of the *tallith* (Jewish prayer shawl). The blue is officially described as “Yale Blue.” It is a lighter shade than used in other Israeli flags.

The merchant flag was adopted in 1948. There is also a naval ensign of similar design.

THE CIVIL ENSIGN



Like other variant Israeli flags, civil and naval ensigns are a darker shade of blue than the national flag

The Shield of David is slightly elongated

THE NAVAL ENSIGN

